

715 Essential Workplace Skills

(formerly 220 Basic Office Systems and Procedures)

Description & Eligibility

Contestants will act as an office intern for Digital Solutions and use given materials to produce accurate business documents that reflect workplace expectations. Any secondary or postsecondary division contestant may enter this application event. Contestants who have previously competed in Essential Workplace Skills or Advanced Workplace Skills cannot enter this event.

Contestant Must Supply

- Published and/or unpublished non-electronic written reference materials
- Cordless calculator: Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards. See NLC Calculator Guidelines. Contestants who violate this rule will be *disqualified*
- Suggested resource: ANSI/ARMA 1-1995 - Alphabetic Filing Rules

Equipment/Supplies Provided

- Computer and software

Contest Notes

- Method of evaluation: objective | application
- AI Policy Level 1 *No AI Allowed*
- All contestant-produced jobs completed on-site are uploaded electronically and are not printed at the national level
- Previous Business Professionals of America tests and/or sample tests (handwritten, photocopied or keyed) may not be taken into the testing area. Violation of this rule will result in disqualification.
- Length of event: no more than ten (10) minutes orientation, no more than ninety (90) minutes testing time, and no more than ten (10) minutes wrap-up
- Entries vary by state

Contest Competencies

1. Demonstrate proficiency in technology and information management by using industry-standard software to create, edit, organize, and format business documents
2. Interpret and analyze provided information to determine appropriate document type, structure, and content, ensuring accuracy
3. Apply effective written communication and professionalism by producing clear, well-formatted documents that follow correct grammar, tone, organizational guidelines, and ethical standards
4. Exhibit employability and workplace skills, including time management, attention to detail, reliability, safety and responsible use of office tools and equipment
5. Organize and maintain office inventory and filing systems using digital tools and ARMA standards